

Write-Up

This project is a clay diorama depicting a small forest microhabitat centred on a decaying tree stump, designed to highlight the diversity of saprobic and mycoparasitic macrofungi that can be found in Singapore. It aims to address fungi blindness by showcasing species with unconventional and visually striking morphologies, rather than the typical capped mushroom form to raise awareness about the societal tendency to overlook fungi diversity that plays an important role in the ecosystem.

The diorama features species such as *Calvatia craniiformis* (Brain/Skull-Shaped Puffball), *Entoloma burkillae* (Cobalt Blue *Entoloma*), *Phallus luteus* (Yellow-Netted Stinkhorn), *Xylaria polymorpha* (Dead Man's Fingers), *Cookeina speciosa* (Pink Champagne Mushroom), *Cyathus striatus* (Fluted Bird's Nest), *Earliella scarbroa* (Polyporales), *Tremella fuciformis* (Snow Fungus), and *Geastrum* sp. (Earthstar), each placed within a plausible ecological context reflective of habitats in Singapore. To further broaden ecological awareness, *Lycogala epidendrum* (Wolf's Milk/Groening's Slime) is included to challenge common misconceptions that such organisms belong to fungi.

Due to artistic, material and scale limitations, some morphological details, such as size, precise colours, textures, and fine structures, e.g. dried sphagnum moss used to represent as leaf litter, gills' thinness for *E. burkillae*, honeycomb structure of *P. luteus*'s pileus, are simplified, and the assemblage represents a curated rather than naturally co-occurring community. Upcycled materials were incorporated to reduce waste and utility of new materials, such as a plastic container as the stump scaffold and fruit netting painted yellow to model the indusium of *Phallus luteus*.

By presenting these unique organisms in a three-dimensional format, the diorama is meant to enhance visual and tactile engagement, fostering greater awareness, curiosity, and appreciation of fungi.

Pictures







References

The following sources have been used for their photographic databases as model references:

Lee, S. M. L., & Choong, A. M. F. (2023). A guide to macrofungi in Singapore. National Parks Board, Singapore Botanic Gardens in collaboration with Department of Biological Sciences, Faculty of Science, National University of Singapore.

Ultimate Mushroom. (2026). <https://ultimate-mushroom.com/>

Mushroom Expert. (2026). <https://www.mushroomexpert.com/>